



RIPOSTE LABORATORIES – BRAND SYSTEM

DOC NO. RL-XXX-A REV. A RIPOSTE LABORATORIES

Aesthetic: industrial spec-sheet × jester mi-parti.
Everything is drawn like a numbered engineering document on bone paper, then cut through with harlequin pink, marigold and teal.

CONTENTS

▶ The five rules	1
▶ Text on colour – the rule that gets broken	2
▶ Fields	2
▶ Structure	3
▶ Voice	3
▶ Files in this skill	4
▶ How to act on this	5

SEC.01

THE FIVE RULES

1. **Ink on bone** – #1d1a17 on #f6f1e7. Never black on white.
2. **Accents rotate** – pink #f0477d → marigold #fe9a0d → teal #12b795, in that order, across repeated elements (nth-child(3n) or 4n with an ink beat). No favourites.
3. **Radius 0**. Everywhere, no exceptions. Only the logo has curves.
4. **No blur**. No soft shadows, no glows, no gradients except the three functional patterns. Depth is a hard 4px 4px 0 offset paired with translate(-2px,-2px).
5. **One font** – JetBrains Mono, 400/700/800. Headings UPPERCASE, prose sentence case, tracking widens as type shrinks (.03em headings → .3em kickers → .55em wordmark).

SEC.02

TEXT ON COLOUR – THE RULE THAT GETS BROKEN

Fixed: bone on pink, INK on marigold, bone on teal.

But bone on pink is 3.16:1 and bone on teal is 2.27:1 – brand-correct, **not text-safe**. Those pairings are legal on chips, spec headers, section bars and large uppercase display only. The moment an accent fill carries a **sentence**, switch to the deep variant: --pink-deep #d81150, --orange-deep #a15e01, --teal-deep #0c7a63 (all ≥4.5:1 with bone). On bone pages, marigold and teal **cannot be text at all** (1.90:1, 2.27:1) – use the deep variants. ink on marigold is 8.12:1, the best pairing in the system.

SEC.03

FIELDS

`data-theme="dark"` → ink field, bone 2px rules, panels #241f1b, dashed #5c554c, accent flips pink→teal. `.pinkfield` → full pink, everything bone, ink label fills, accent goes marigold. Fields nest; `data-theme="light"` makes a bone island inside a dark subtree.

SEC.04

STRUCTURE

2px solid rules structure everything; 1px dashed dividers separate rows; 6px accent top-bars mark cards and steps; 8px left-bars mark notes and pull quotes. No hairlines.

Spacing: 4 8 12 16 24 34 48 64 72. Memorise three – **16px** default padding and paragraph spacing, **34px** under every section head and every grid gap, **64px** section padding. Containers `min(1060px, 92vw)`; body copy caps at 66ch.

Signature separators: 22px checker band (26px strip) and 34px pink/teal harlequin band (38px strip) – alternate them down a page, always strips, never large fields. Tri-band gradient `linear-gradient(105deg, pink 0 36%, orange 36% 64%, teal 64% 100%)` fills page heads and the footer's right cell.

Spec-sheet chrome everywhere: “, SEC.NN chips, // slash tags, REV. A, corner marks. Glyphs ▶ ✓ × ! → ↓ ♻ instead of icon fonts.

Motion: 120/150/250ms, plain easing, marquee 28s linear. No scroll-triggered fades, no parallax, no entrance animations.

SEC.05

VOICE

Two registers, both mono. **The document** (uppercase, tracked): chrome and identifiers. **The engineer** (sentence case): prose – plainspoken, concrete, wit from precision not jokes. Bold the numbers that matter (**14.46 Wh**). No exclamation marks. No marketing verbs. Placeholder loud and honest (\$[TAM], ▲ Illustrative).

SEC.06

FILES IN THIS SKILL

NEED	FILE
Drop-in stylesheet (tokens + base + patterns)	brand/riposte-brand.css
Machine-readable source of truth	brand/tokens.json
Sass / Tailwind	brand/tokens.scss, brand/tailwind.preset.js
Every colour in every notation + contrast matrix	docs/color-reference.md
Reasoning: colour, type, spacing, logo, patterns, voice, ally, print	docs/0*.md
Per-tool setup	tools/canva.md, figma.md, google-workspace.md, office.md, adobe-affinity.md, inkscape-gimp.md, web.md
Swatch files	palettes/riposte.{ase,gpl,sketchpalette,csv,json}
Logos (ink / bone / pink fills)	assets/logo/
The whole system rendered	specimen/index.html

SEC.07

HOW TO ACT ON THIS

Building a web page, app, or HTML artifact – link or inline `brand/riposte-brand.css` and use the production class names: `.pagehead+.kicker`, `.sechead+.no+.tag`, `.spec`, `.verdict`, `.flow`, `.chip`, `.note`, `.pull`, `.stat`, `.partner`, `.marquee`, `.cta`, `.bigmail`, `.corner`, `footer.colophon`, `p.lead`, `.dim`, `.hi`. Close every page with the colophon. Mark decorative bands and SEC.NN chips `aria-hidden="true"`.

Writing documentation – sentence-case Markdown headings (uppercase fights GitHub's renderer and hurts search), `DOC NO./REV.` chrome stays uppercase, tables over prose, close with the brand colophon block.

Working in a design tool – read the matching `tools/*.md` first. Each one has the exact values, the tool's letter-spacing unit conversion, how to rebuild the bands without conic gradients, and the two or three defaults that tool gets wrong (almost always: rounded corners and blurred shadows).

Changing a token – edit `brand/tokens.json`, then run `node scripts/build.js`. It regenerates every export and fails if the stylesheet drifts, a deep accent stops clearing 4.5:1, a non-zero radius appears, a shadow gains blur, or the ASE stops round-tripping.

If asked to add a colour – push back. There are three accents. For more chart categories: rotate the three, add the ink beat, then bone-dim with an ink border, then the `-deep` variants. Past eight, split the chart.

Source of truth: <https://github.com/armeehn/riposte-brand>

SOURCE SKILL.md SHA fd9e56cbd5a8 BUILT 2026-08-15

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